STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE			G-9100
	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 12/04/06	DATE REVISED **01/14/25**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		
CHAPTER TITLE GENERAL		RESOURCES		
SUBJECT REPORT REQUIREMENTS		CROSS REFERENCE G-2100 STANDARDS OF CONDUCT		

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish the guidelines for the completion of written reports by Sheriff's Office personnel.

II. Policy:

Record keeping is an integral part of any law enforcement agency. Timely, accurate reports provide necessary information for successful investigation and prosecution of criminal cases, provide input for planning future law enforcement operations, and fulfill statutory obligations.

III. Procedure:

A. Report Types: Although the Sheriff's Office maintains a large number of report forms, generally, most reports shall be completed using the Sarpy County Sheriff's Office Incident form unless directed by specific policy.

1. **Incident Report:** Incident reports shall be completed for any criminal act or major non-criminal incident (e.g. industrial accident, plane crash, etc.).

2. **Arrest Report:** Arrest reports shall be completed any time a citation is issued for a criminal offense excluding minor traffic offenses.

3. **Information Report:** An information report shall be completed when an incident is non-criminal or civil in nature but the information may be necessary for future investigation or the deputy believes the incident may be scrutinized by the public. Information reports may also be completed when a deputy believes the incident should be documented, but it does not meet the criteria of an incident report.

4. **Supplemental Report:** A supplemental report shall be completed for any additional investigation related to an original incident report. Supplemental reports may also be completed when a deputy substantively contributes to an incident and another deputy has completed the original incident report. Supplemental reports need only contain the original report number and a narrative.

   a) Substantive contributions to an incident may include:

   (1) A deputy uses force beyond soft empty hand control.
   (2) A deputy takes a statement from a victim, suspect, or witness.
   (3) A deputy locates and/or takes custody of evidence.

   b) Supplemental reports shall list the original report number and any new report number obtained shall be listed in the related report number field (e.g. a deputy recovers stolen property or locates a runaway, the original report number shall be listed in the report number field and the new report number shall be located in the related report number field).

5. **Affidavit:** An affidavit is a written statement of facts a deputy swears to be true before an authorized official, such as a judge or notary public. Deputies use affidavits to document evidence, support requests for warrants, and record witness statements. The affidavit must accurately reflect the deputy's knowledge or belief and be made in accordance with Nebraska law. Affidavits shall be completed for arrest warrant requests, search warrants, warrantless arrests, child removals, and wherever specified in policy or statute.

   a) Affidavits shall not be complete copies of incident or arrest reports. The body of an affidavit shall contain the pertinent information specific to the purpose of the affidavit.

6. **Tavern Report:** A tavern report form shall be completed for incidents occurring at an establishment which has been granted a liquor license (e.g., bars, pubs, V.F.W halls, etc.) and a violation of a liquor law may have occurred. This shall include any incidents directly related to the sale of liquor at licensed establishments (e.g. the sale of alcohol to a minor, the sale of alcohol after hours, disturbance on property of establishment holding a liquor license, etc.”). Tavern reports shall be forwarded to the Nebraska Liquor Commission and the Nebraska State Patrol.

B. Reporting Procedures:

1. All reports shall be completed prior to a deputy going off-duty.

a) A deputy, with good cause, may request permission from his/her supervisor to complete a report on his/her next shift.

(1) If the report is being forwarded to the Investigations Division for follow-up, it must be completed prior to the initial responding deputy going off-duty and an extension request cannot be granted.

2. All reports shall be completed using black or blue ink.

3. Report numbers shall be written in the format of the two-digit year, followed by a dash, and ended with the unique report number. (i.e., 20-12345).

a) There should not be any leading zeroes before the unique report number.

4. All relevant information shall be included on the report form. If information is unavailable, deputies should note in the narrative the reason why it was unavailable.

5. Reports shall be completed under the following circumstances:

a) A crime has been committed.
b) Further investigation may be necessary.
c) Current information may be helpful in future investigations.
d) A deputy takes enforcement action including:

(1) Use of force beyond soft empty hand control*.
(2) High-Risk traffic stops*.
(3) Placing a subject into custody (with the exception of a warrant arrest).
(4) Deputy points his or her weapon at an individual*.
(5) Deputy involved in a vehicle pursuit*.

(*) the deputy shall also be required to immediately notify his or her supervisor.

e) There is an indication that the general public may scrutinize the deputy's actions or the Sheriff's Office policies.
f) There is a death or a probable death.
g) There is additional or supplemental information to a previous incident.
h) A traffic crash requires a state crash report and an incident report, if injuries are reported.
i) Policy requires the completion of a written report.
j) There is any question that a written report is required.

6. Activity by a deputy that is self-initiated or dispatched/assigned and does not involve any of the above examples listed in III. B. 6. will not require a separate report or narrative beyond the information recorded by the call-taker or dispatcher. However, it is the deputy's responsibility to ensure that all relevant information is included in the call notes and updated as needed.

7. A supervisor shall review all reports completed by subordinate employees after being returned from transcription.

8. Errors: Employees locating errors on their reports shall make the necessary corrections and ensure transcription is provided the updates to the report.

C. **Report Narratives:** Narratives shall be accurate, detailed, and chronological.

1. To ensure complete and accurate transcription of narratives, they must be emailed to the "Sheriff Transcription" email group, accompanied by all related forms (i.e., incident form/coversheet, witness statements, etc). Handwritten forms can be submitted to the inbox in the Road Patrol Deputy Work Area.

2. Names shall be written as "First Name LAST NAME" (Example: John SMITH)

3. Incident report narratives shall use the full name and date of birth when identifying individuals for the first time in the narrative. (Example: John DOE (DOB:01/01/1990). This applies to both adults and juveniles.

4. Incident report narratives shall be concluded with one of the following:

a) This case is considered closed in the files of this office.

b) This case is considered open in the files of this office. Further reports are forthcoming.

c) This case is considered open in the files of this office. Please forward a copy of this report to the Investigations Division for follow-up.

d) This report is supplemental only. Please refer to related case reports.

D. **Affidavit Narratives:** Affidavit narratives shall be accurate, detailed, chronological, and specifically written for the purpose of the affidavit.

1. Juvenile names shall be recorded in the affidavit with initials and year of birth. (Example: J.D., 2016).

2. Adult names shall be recorded in the affidavit with full name and year of birth. (Example: John DOE, 1992)

3. If there is a form field requesting a full name for a juvenile, or a date of birth for any person, deputies shall fill the form field with the requested information.

4. Affidavits shall not have internal communication wording, such as “The ADC was notified of the incident.” or “I submitted my body-worn camera footage to evidence”.

E. **Internal Communications**: Internal communications, such as emails, ADC reports, intelligence bulletins, etc. may use full names and do not need to be amended to hide identities.